

# Donavan Watley

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

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Software Engineering student at the College of Charleston with hands-on experience in application development, research, and technical instruction. Background as a U.S. Navy Aviation Electronics Technician brings a strong foundation in high-reliability systems, security principles, and structured problem-solving. Skilled in Java, Python, and JavaScript, with practical experience in OOP, data pipelines, and developer tooling.

## EDUCATION

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### College of Charleston

*Bachelor of Software Engineering, Minor in Applied Artificial Intelligence, Minor in Classics.*

Charleston, SC

May 2028

## EXPERIENCE

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### Undergraduate Researcher

January 2026 – Present

*College of Charleston*

*Charleston, SC*

- Build interactive applications that collect and process behavioral data using structured data pipelines and file-based storage
- Design privacy-aware systems separating sensitive local data from processed analytics, applying secure data handling principles
- Apply HCI and accessible UI/UX principles to create adaptive, user-focused applications with persistent data and system logic

### Teaching Assistant, Computer Programming II (Java)

January 2026 – Present

*College of Charleston*

*Charleston, SC*

- Debug and refactor student code while reinforcing best practices including modular design, separation of concerns, and testability
- Mentor 20+ students in OOP, algorithms, and problem-solving while guiding them through multi-class application development
- Support fast-paced lab environments using Agile-style workflows, helping students deliver functional, testable software

### Aviation Electronics Technician

May 2019 – May 2024

*United States Navy*

*Virginia Beach, VA*

- Maintained mission-critical avionics systems, applying cybersecurity principles and access control in high-reliability environments
- Diagnosed and resolved complex system failures using structured troubleshooting, improving uptime and operational reliability
- Upheld documentation accuracy and strict operational and security standards across all system readiness activities

### Independent Business Owner

August 2024 – Present

*Rover*

- Manage a service-based business handling client scheduling, communication, and service tracking across concurrent engagements
- Maintain consistent reporting and client communication, ensuring reliable service delivery and high customer satisfaction

## PROJECTS

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### jrDev <https://donnyboy72.github.io/Junior-Dev-to-Pro/>

April 2026 – Present

*JavaScript, HTML, CSS*

- Designed and built a platform teaching real-world engineering skills including Git, Docker, debugging, and system design
- Developed interactive, game-based modules to simulate real-world development workflows and engineering decision-making
- Modeled software architectures to help users understand distributed systems concepts and development pipelines

### MazeRunner <https://github.com/donnyboy72/MazeRunner>

March 2026 – May 2026

*Java*

- Developed a Java maze game featuring dynamic map exploration, movement logic, and error handling
- Engineered a randomized maze generation system using Depth-First Search (DFS) to ensure solvable mazes
- Implemented movement management using a custom delimiter class to efficiently track wall collisions and player state

### True Memory Game <https://github.com/donnyboy72/TrueMemoryGame>

January 2026 – Present

*Undergraduate Research*

- Built interactive research applications that collect and process behavioral data through structured pipelines and file-based storage

## CERTIFICATIONS

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- IBM DevOps and Software Engineering Professional Certificate

## SKILLS

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**Languages:** Java, Python, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Rust

**Software Engineering:** OOP, Data Structures & Algorithms, Debugging, File I/O, Exception Handling

**Developer Tools:** Git, GitHub, Docker, VS Code, GitHub Codespaces, Eclipse, Google Workspace